

Field Artillery

Although modern rifled artillery made of cast or wrought iron was used during the war, the most common gun was the so-called Napoleon cannon, a brass smoothbore that fired round shot, spherical case shot, and canister. It normally took six horses to pull a gun and its limber. Ammunition was transported on a caisson, also pulled by a limber and a team of six horses. A Union artillery battery, commanded by a captain, consisted of six guns. Each cannon had a crew of a sergeant and seven men.



^[1] Canister shot was fired at short range against infantry. The tin canister was filled with lead slugs and sawdust. Upon exiting the muzzle, the container disintegrated and the deadly balls fanned out.